

UNIT 2: THE GLOBAL ECONOMY

Class Time: 75 Minutes

Description

This lesson takes the form of a simulation game. Your students will become major players in the global economy to find out what role major economic global institutions play in trade and how countries engage in international trade (See Activity 5). As a homework assignment, your students will be asked to analyse the impact of global trade on a selected country.

Curriculum Expectations

The Global Economy Game

Overall Expectations

SSV.02 – analyse the causes and effects of economic disparities around the world.

HEV.01 – analyse selected global trends and evaluate their effects on people and environments at the local, national, and global level.

GCV.01– demonstrate an understanding of the interdependence of countries in the global economy.

Specific Expectations

SS1.01 – demonstrate an understanding of the interdependence of ecology and economics.

SS1.05 – identify ways in which countries and regions of the world are becoming increasingly interdependent.

HE2.06 – explain ways in which trade policies or agreements may affect the environment.

GC2.01 – analyse the economic and environmental consequences for selected countries of colonialism in the past and economic colonialism in the present.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

- Awareness of concepts of international trade (e.g. export, import, global corporations).
- Some knowledge of global economic institutions and regulations (e.g. IMF, World Bank, IMF, GATT, NAFTA).
- Web searching, critical thinking, group work.

Planning Notes

- Photocopy Supplementary Sheets 3 to 8.
- Photocopy Student Activity Sheets 4 to 8.
- Read the instructions and game cards thoroughly. You should spend an hour reading and preparing the game to be comfortable with it.
- Review the glossary of terms and be prepared to define any for the class.

Teaching/Learning Strategies

Most of the learning strategies are described in each activity, but here are some of the overall strategies for the unit.

- Introduce students to the concept of the global economy.

- Examine the historical path of globalisation by identifying the policies and international commitments and the effect of the implementation of local, national, and global issues.
- Identify individuals who have made a significant contribution to globalisation.
- Introduce the students to new vocabulary and the new concepts listed in each activity. Refer them to the glossary.
- Refer the students to the accompanying material, the supplementary sheets, and where to go find information.
- Assign students the suggested homework and encourage students to do an in-depth analysis of the information provided and to research the websites given.
- Monitor the group work and simulation games so the benefits are maximized for your students.

Accommodations

Frequent monitoring and assistance should be provided. Accommodations that are normally provided in the regular classroom for students with special needs should be provided. Here are some strategies for helping them.

- Information should be presented in as many modalities as possible through oral presentations, board notes, diagrams, class discussions, activity-based learning.
- Instructions should be clear, concise, to the point, verbally rehearsed by the student, properly sequenced, reviewed after a time lapse, written down on the board or in a notebook.
- Assignments should be outlined in writing, written in the students' homework/assignment book, written (and left) on the blackboard, broken down step by step with the teacher, rehearsed/modelled, and scheduled step by step.
- Questioning should be clear, concise, allowing for appropriate response time. Students need to organise their thoughts, match them with appropriate vocabulary, put them in correct syntax, sequence the ideas and finally express them with good speech. These skills are often taken for granted when teaching new concepts.
- Encourage students to question for clarification and additional information. Learn to speak at a lower rate of speech. Avoid figurative language unless it has been specifically pre-taught. Encourage and evaluate oral responses and class participation. Allow extra time (e.g. homework) for students to complete assignments that other students may finish in class time. Create extra practice opportunities with new vocabulary or concepts. Provide overviews or lesson highlights at the beginning of class. Discuss and simplify sophisticated vocabulary or language. Finally, give several short assignments rather than one long one.